

EVIDENCE • LEDGER • STRUCTURE

kpi

Executive KPI system — one base, five layout modifiers.

Four tiles the eye sweeps in one pass.

4

tiles per row

THE CEILING (ON PLAN)



8

words per tile

SOFT BUDGET **BOARD**

5S

scan time

THE TARGET **ON PLAN**

O

prose sentences

ALLOWED HERE **AUDIT**

KPI ATTENTION

attention flags the tile that misses.

1

tile flagged

THE MISSATTENTION

3

tiles steady

FOR CONTEXTON PLAN

0

alarms hidden

HONESTYBOARD

4

tiles total

THE ROWON PLAN

KPI OPS

ops reads the tiles against SLOs.

99.9%

the SLO frame

TARGET LINE SLO

4

tiles per row

UNCHANGED ON PLAN

1

breach shown

NEVER HIDDEN OPS

30d

the window

ROLLING SLO

KPI COMPLIANCE

compliance tallies findings per framework.

0

open findings

THE GOAL CLEAN

4

frameworks tracked

ONE ROW AUDIT

1

in remediation

DATED WATCH

KPI TRAJECTORY

trajectory pairs each tile with its delta.

+9%

the delta leads

VS PLAN **UP**

4

tiles still rule

PER ROW **ON PLAN**

−2

down is shown

NOT SPUN **HONEST**

KPI SPOTLIGHT

spotlight gives one tile double width.

1

tile promoted

the headline **SPOTLIGHT**



2

support tiles

BESIDE IT **ON PLAN**

0

competing heroes

ONE ONLY **RULE**

Four tiles at full word weight is the ceiling.

4

tiles is the grid's seat count

A FIFTH NEVER RENDERS **MAX**



14

words per tile, the hard budget

THIS TILE SPENDS ITS WHOLE ALLOWANCE

BUDGET

1

line per label before wrapping

WRAPPING ENDS THE FIVE-SECOND SCAN

RULE

2

slides beat one crowded grid

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When NOT to reach for kpi.

Decorative pills without status semantics

The pills read as status, not freeform tags. Status color is assigned by each KPI's row position within the modifier — the engine never reads the pill text — so reserve them for the status vocabulary the position implies (`On plan`, `At risk`, `Breaching`, `Compliant`, `Remediating`). Arbitrary labels land a color that has nothing to do with the words.

More than four KPIs in attention or spotlight

`attention` highlights the metric that needs the room; `spotlight` monumentalizes one number. Past four KPIs the visual hierarchy collapses — split into two slides.

No targets, no trends

If the KPIs carry only current values, the slide is a stats row, not a kpi dashboard. Use stats and reclaim the room.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`stats` — metric row without targets or status pills

`big-number` — a single number is the whole argument

`split-panel` — one KPI with a paragraph of supporting prose

`progress` — completion percentages across parallel workstreams

`timeline-list` — milestones in time, not metrics at a moment